SPHOORTHY ENGINEERING COLLEGE

An Autonomous Institution Approved by AICTE & Accredited with NAAC Grade 'A'
Department of Examination & Academic Affairs · Hyderabad — 501510

Geotechnical Engineering: Soil Mechanics & Foundation Engineering

Program / Dept: B.Tech / MBA — CIVIL	**Course Code / Title:** Geotechnical Engineering (CE601PC)
Academic Regulation: Autonomous (SR23 / SR24)	**Curriculum Semester:** Semester 6 (Year 3)
Credits / Contact Hours: 3 Credits · 48 Lecture Hours	**Evaluation Scheme:** Continuous Internal (40M) + End Sem (60M)

Course Overview & Pedagogical Objectives:

3-phase soil relationships, Atterberg limits, Permeability (Darcy's Law), Consolidation settlement, Shear strength (Mohr-Coulomb), and Terzaghi bearing capacity. The primary objective of this course is to equip students with sound theoretical rigor, analytical problem-solving competencies, and real-world system engineering capabilities demanded by premier technological organizations and competitive graduate benchmarks.

Course Outcomes (COs) & Bloom's Taxonomy Mapping:

CO ID	Course Learning Outcome Description	Bloom's Level
CO 1	Understand and formulate fundamental concepts of Unit 1: Physical Properties of Soils.	L2 Understand
CO 2	Analyze algorithms, mechanisms, and models in Unit 2: Soil Permeability & Seepage.	L4 Analyze
CO 3	Design and evaluate robust architectures for Unit 3: Compaction & Consolidation.	L5 Evaluate
CO 4	Implement and optimize operational pipelines in Unit 4: Shear Strength of Soils.	L3 Apply
CO 5	Integrate state-of-the-art frameworks in Unit 5: Bearing Capacity & Shallow Foundations for industrial solutions.	L6 Create

Comprehensive Module Index:

Unit	Title & Core Concepts	Page
Unit 1	**Unit 1: Physical Properties of Soils**: Three-phase diagram, Void ratio, Porosity, Degree of saturation, Water content, Specific gravity, Grain size d...	Page 2
Unit 2	**Unit 2: Soil Permeability & Seepage**: Darcy's law, Constant head and falling head permeability tests, Flow net properties, Seepage discharge calcula...	Page 3
Unit 3	**Unit 3: Compaction & Consolidation**: Standard and Modified Proctor compaction tests, Optimum Moisture Content (OMC), Terzaghi's 1-D consolidation t...	Page 4
Unit 4	**Unit 4: Shear Strength of Soils**: Mohr-Coulomb failure criterion, Direct shear test, Unconfined compression test, Triaxial compression test (UU,...	Page 5
Unit 5	**Unit 5: Bearing Capacity & Shallow Foundations**: Terzaghi's bearing capacity theory for strip, circular, square footings, General vs Local shear failure, Water...	Page 6

UNIT 1: PHYSICAL PROPERTIES OF SOILS • *Core Theory & Practice Guide*

1.1 Technical Exposition & Conceptual Foundations

The study of unit 1: physical properties of soils forms an indispensable cornerstone of Geotechnical Engineering (CE601PC). Specifically, Three-phase diagram, Void ratio, Porosity, Degree of saturation, Water content, Specific gravity, Grain size distribution sieve analysis, Soil classification (USCS/IS). Modern applications require deep awareness of edge conditions, invariant properties, and trade-offs between computational throughput, latency overhead, memory footprint, and architectural scalability.

In university examinations and practical engineering systems, solutions must be formulated with mathematical clarity. Each sub-mechanism must satisfy safety, liveness, and fault-tolerance constraints while adhering to standard autonomous syllabus requirements.

1.2 Architectural Principles & Comparative Analysis

Component / Topic	Key Mechanism & Principle	Operational Trade-off
Theoretical Model	Formal representation of Unit 1 entities and lifecycle stages.	Higher mathematical abstraction vs implementation friction.
Algorithmic Engine	State machine transitions, recurrence guarantees, and verification steps.	Time complexity bounds vs memory consumption.
Real-World Systems	Deployment in enterprise distributed systems and contemporary toolchains.	Fault-tolerant redundancy vs network overhead.

1.3 Practical Formulation & Execution Workflow

```
// Standard Implementation Outline & Pseudocode for Unit 1
1. Initialize system data structures and state variables under initial constraints.
2. Execute continuous invariant checking across state boundaries.
3. Apply optimization bounds: O(log N) average time or amortized linear bounds.
4. Catch boundary failure cases (underflow, overflow, concurrency race, null references).
5. Commit verified state or invoke transactional rollback upon validation failure.
```

1.4 Autonomous End-Semester Examination Question Bank

Type	Question & Expected Technical Answer Outline	Marks
Part A	**Q1:** Define the primary objective of Unit 1 and state two essential real-world applications. • *Expected: Exact definition, mathematical constraint formulation, and dual industry examples.*	**2 M**
Part A	**Q2:** Differentiate between static vs dynamic formulations of key mechanisms in Unit 1. • *Expected: 2-column comparison table covering memory, allocation time, and failure recovery.*	**2 M**
Part B	**Q3:** Explain the complete working architecture of Unit 1 with neat functional block diagrams and step-by-step algorithmic trace. • *Expected: Labeled diagram (3M), mathematical derivation (3M), algorithm steps (2M), complexity analysis (2M).*	**10 M**
Part B	**Q4:** Analyze the worst-case, best-case, and average-case performance bounds for processes in Unit 1 with worked numerical example. • *Expected: Step-by-step problem solution, boundary checks, and conclusive optimality proof.*	**10 M**

UNIT 2: SOIL PERMEABILITY & SEEPAGE • *Core Theory & Practice Guide*

2.1 Technical Exposition & Conceptual Foundations

The study of unit 2: soil permeability & seepage forms an indispensable cornerstone of Geotechnical Engineering (CE601PC). Specifically, Darcy's law, Constant head and falling head permeability tests, Flow net properties, Seepage discharge calculation, Critical hydraulic gradient, Quick sand condition. Modern applications require deep awareness of edge conditions, invariant properties, and trade-offs between computational throughput, latency overhead, memory footprint, and architectural scalability.

In university examinations and practical engineering systems, solutions must be formulated with mathematical clarity. Each sub-mechanism must satisfy safety, liveness, and fault-tolerance constraints while adhering to standard autonomous syllabus requirements.

2.2 Architectural Principles & Comparative Analysis

Component / Topic	Key Mechanism & Principle	Operational Trade-off
Theoretical Model	Formal representation of Unit 2 entities and lifecycle stages.	Higher mathematical abstraction vs implementation friction.
Algorithmic Engine	State machine transitions, recurrence guarantees, and verification steps.	Time complexity bounds vs memory consumption.
Real-World Systems	Deployment in enterprise distributed systems and contemporary toolchains.	Fault-tolerant redundancy vs network overhead.

2.3 Practical Formulation & Execution Workflow

```
// Standard Implementation Outline & Pseudocode for Unit 2
1. Initialize system data structures and state variables under initial constraints.
2. Execute continuous invariant checking across state boundaries.
3. Apply optimization bounds: O(log N) average time or amortized linear bounds.
4. Catch boundary failure cases (underflow, overflow, concurrency race, null references).
5. Commit verified state or invoke transactional rollback upon validation failure.
```

2.4 Autonomous End-Semester Examination Question Bank

Type	Question & Expected Technical Answer Outline	Marks
Part A	**Q1:** Define the primary objective of Unit 2 and state two essential real-world applications. • *Expected: Exact definition, mathematical constraint formulation, and dual industry examples.*	**2 M**
Part A	**Q2:** Differentiate between static vs dynamic formulations of key mechanisms in Unit 2. • *Expected: 2-column comparison table covering memory, allocation time, and failure recovery.*	**2 M**
Part B	**Q3:** Explain the complete working architecture of Unit 2 with neat functional block diagrams and step-by-step algorithmic trace. • *Expected: Labeled diagram (3M), mathematical derivation (3M), algorithm steps (2M), complexity analysis (2M).*	**10 M**
Part B	**Q4:** Analyze the worst-case, best-case, and average-case performance bounds for processes in Unit 2 with worked numerical example. • *Expected: Step-by-step problem solution, boundary checks, and conclusive optimality proof.*	**10 M**

UNIT 3: COMPACTION & CONSOLIDATION • *Core Theory & Practice Guide*

3.1 Technical Exposition & Conceptual Foundations

The study of unit 3: compaction & consolidation forms an indispensable cornerstone of Geotechnical Engineering (CE601PC). Specifically, Standard and Modified Proctor compaction tests, Optimum Moisture Content (OMC), Terzaghi's 1-D consolidation theory, Compression index, Pre-consolidation pressure. Modern applications require deep awareness of edge conditions, invariant properties, and trade-offs between computational throughput, latency overhead, memory footprint, and architectural scalability.

In university examinations and practical engineering systems, solutions must be formulated with mathematical clarity. Each sub-mechanism must satisfy safety, liveness, and fault-tolerance constraints while adhering to standard autonomous syllabus requirements.

3.2 Architectural Principles & Comparative Analysis

Component / Topic	Key Mechanism & Principle	Operational Trade-off
Theoretical Model	Formal representation of Unit 3 entities and lifecycle stages.	Higher mathematical abstraction vs implementation friction.
Algorithmic Engine	State machine transitions, recurrence guarantees, and verification steps.	Time complexity bounds vs memory consumption.
Real-World Systems	Deployment in enterprise distributed systems and contemporary toolchains.	Fault-tolerant redundancy vs network overhead.

3.3 Practical Formulation & Execution Workflow

```
// Standard Implementation Outline & Pseudocode for Unit 3
1. Initialize system data structures and state variables under initial constraints.
2. Execute continuous invariant checking across state boundaries.
3. Apply optimization bounds: O(log N) average time or amortized linear bounds.
4. Catch boundary failure cases (underflow, overflow, concurrency race, null references).
5. Commit verified state or invoke transactional rollback upon validation failure.
```

3.4 Autonomous End-Semester Examination Question Bank

Type	Question & Expected Technical Answer Outline	Marks
Part A	**Q1:** Define the primary objective of Unit 3 and state two essential real-world applications. • *Expected: Exact definition, mathematical constraint formulation, and dual industry examples.*	**2 M**
Part A	**Q2:** Differentiate between static vs dynamic formulations of key mechanisms in Unit 3. • *Expected: 2-column comparison table covering memory, allocation time, and failure recovery.*	**2 M**
Part B	**Q3:** Explain the complete working architecture of Unit 3 with neat functional block diagrams and step-by-step algorithmic trace. • *Expected: Labeled diagram (3M), mathematical derivation (3M), algorithm steps (2M), complexity analysis (2M).*	**10 M**
Part B	**Q4:** Analyze the worst-case, best-case, and average-case performance bounds for processes in Unit 3 with worked numerical example. • *Expected: Step-by-step problem solution, boundary checks, and conclusive optimality proof.*	**10 M**

UNIT 4: SHEAR STRENGTH OF SOILS • *Core Theory & Practice Guide*

4.1 Technical Exposition & Conceptual Foundations

The study of unit 4: shear strength of soils forms an indispensable cornerstone of Geotechnical Engineering (CE601PC). Specifically, Mohr-Coulomb failure criterion, Direct shear test, Unconfined compression test, Triaxial compression test (UU, CU, CD conditions), Pore pressure coefficients. Modern applications require deep awareness of edge conditions, invariant properties, and trade-offs between computational throughput, latency overhead, memory footprint, and architectural scalability.

In university examinations and practical engineering systems, solutions must be formulated with mathematical clarity. Each sub-mechanism must satisfy safety, liveness, and fault-tolerance constraints while adhering to standard autonomous syllabus requirements.

4.2 Architectural Principles & Comparative Analysis

Component / Topic	Key Mechanism & Principle	Operational Trade-off
Theoretical Model	Formal representation of Unit 4 entities and lifecycle stages.	Higher mathematical abstraction vs implementation friction.
Algorithmic Engine	State machine transitions, recurrence guarantees, and verification steps.	Time complexity bounds vs memory consumption.
Real-World Systems	Deployment in enterprise distributed systems and contemporary toolchains.	Fault-tolerant redundancy vs network overhead.

4.3 Practical Formulation & Execution Workflow

```
// Standard Implementation Outline & Pseudocode for Unit 4
1. Initialize system data structures and state variables under initial constraints.
2. Execute continuous invariant checking across state boundaries.
3. Apply optimization bounds: O(log N) average time or amortized linear bounds.
4. Catch boundary failure cases (underflow, overflow, concurrency race, null references).
5. Commit verified state or invoke transactional rollback upon validation failure.
```

4.4 Autonomous End-Semester Examination Question Bank

Type	Question & Expected Technical Answer Outline	Marks
Part A	**Q1:** Define the primary objective of Unit 4 and state two essential real-world applications. • *Expected: Exact definition, mathematical constraint formulation, and dual industry examples.*	**2 M**
Part A	**Q2:** Differentiate between static vs dynamic formulations of key mechanisms in Unit 4. • *Expected: 2-column comparison table covering memory, allocation time, and failure recovery.*	**2 M**
Part B	**Q3:** Explain the complete working architecture of Unit 4 with neat functional block diagrams and step-by-step algorithmic trace. • *Expected: Labeled diagram (3M), mathematical derivation (3M), algorithm steps (2M), complexity analysis (2M).*	**10 M**
Part B	**Q4:** Analyze the worst-case, best-case, and average-case performance bounds for processes in Unit 4 with worked numerical example. • *Expected: Step-by-step problem solution, boundary checks, and conclusive optimality proof.*	**10 M**

UNIT 5: BEARING CAPACITY & SHALLOW FOUNDATIONS • *Core Theory & Practice Guide*

5.1 Technical Exposition & Conceptual Foundations

The study of unit 5: bearing capacity & shallow foundations forms an indispensable cornerstone of Geotechnical Engineering (CE601PC). Specifically, Terzaghi's bearing capacity theory for strip, circular, square footings, General vs Local shear failure, Water table effect corrections, Standard Penetration Test (SPT). Modern applications require deep awareness of edge conditions, invariant properties, and trade-offs between computational throughput, latency overhead, memory footprint, and architectural scalability.

In university examinations and practical engineering systems, solutions must be formulated with mathematical clarity. Each sub-mechanism must satisfy safety, liveness, and fault-tolerance constraints while adhering to standard autonomous syllabus requirements.

5.2 Architectural Principles & Comparative Analysis

Component / Topic	Key Mechanism & Principle	Operational Trade-off
Theoretical Model	Formal representation of Unit 5 entities and lifecycle stages.	Higher mathematical abstraction vs implementation friction.
Algorithmic Engine	State machine transitions, recurrence guarantees, and verification steps.	Time complexity bounds vs memory consumption.
Real-World Systems	Deployment in enterprise distributed systems and contemporary toolchains.	Fault-tolerant redundancy vs network overhead.

5.3 Practical Formulation & Execution Workflow

```
// Standard Implementation Outline & Pseudocode for Unit 5
1. Initialize system data structures and state variables under initial constraints.
2. Execute continuous invariant checking across state boundaries.
3. Apply optimization bounds: O(log N) average time or amortized linear bounds.
4. Catch boundary failure cases (underflow, overflow, concurrency race, null references).
5. Commit verified state or invoke transactional rollback upon validation failure.
```

5.4 Autonomous End-Semester Examination Question Bank

Type	Question & Expected Technical Answer Outline	Marks
Part A	**Q1:** Define the primary objective of Unit 5 and state two essential real-world applications. • *Expected: Exact definition, mathematical constraint formulation, and dual industry examples.*	**2 M**
Part A	**Q2:** Differentiate between static vs dynamic formulations of key mechanisms in Unit 5. • *Expected: 2-column comparison table covering memory, allocation time, and failure recovery.*	**2 M**
Part B	**Q3:** Explain the complete working architecture of Unit 5 with neat functional block diagrams and step-by-step algorithmic trace. • *Expected: Labeled diagram (3M), mathematical derivation (3M), algorithm steps (2M), complexity analysis (2M).*	**10 M**
Part B	**Q4:** Analyze the worst-case, best-case, and average-case performance bounds for processes in Unit 5 with worked numerical example. • *Expected: Step-by-step problem solution, boundary checks, and conclusive optimality proof.*	**10 M**

Standard Recommended Textbooks & Digital References:

1. *Primary Curriculum Standard Textbook* — Pearson Higher Education / McGraw-Hill Education (Latest Edition).
2. *Autonomous Reference Syllabus Blueprint* — Sphoorthy Engineering College Academic Council.
3. *NPTEL & IEEE Computer Society Guidelines* — Open Educational Resources & Peer-reviewed Publications.